

3.6 Fundamentals of computer systems

3.6.1 Hardware and software

3.6.1.1 Relationship between hardware and software

Content	Additional information
Understand the relationship between hardware and software and be able to define the terms: • hardware • software.	

3.6.1.2 Classification of software

Content	Additional information
Explain what is meant by: • system software • application software.	
Understand the need for, and attributes of, different types of software.	

3.6.1.3 System software

Content	Additional information
Understand the need for, and functions of the following system software: • operating systems (OSs) • utility programs • libraries • translators (compiler, assembler, interpreter).	

3.6.1.4 Role of an operating system (OS)

Content	Additional information
Understand that a role of the operating system is to hide the complexities of the hardware.	
Know that the OS handles resource management, managing hardware to allocate processors, memories and I/O devices among competing processes.	